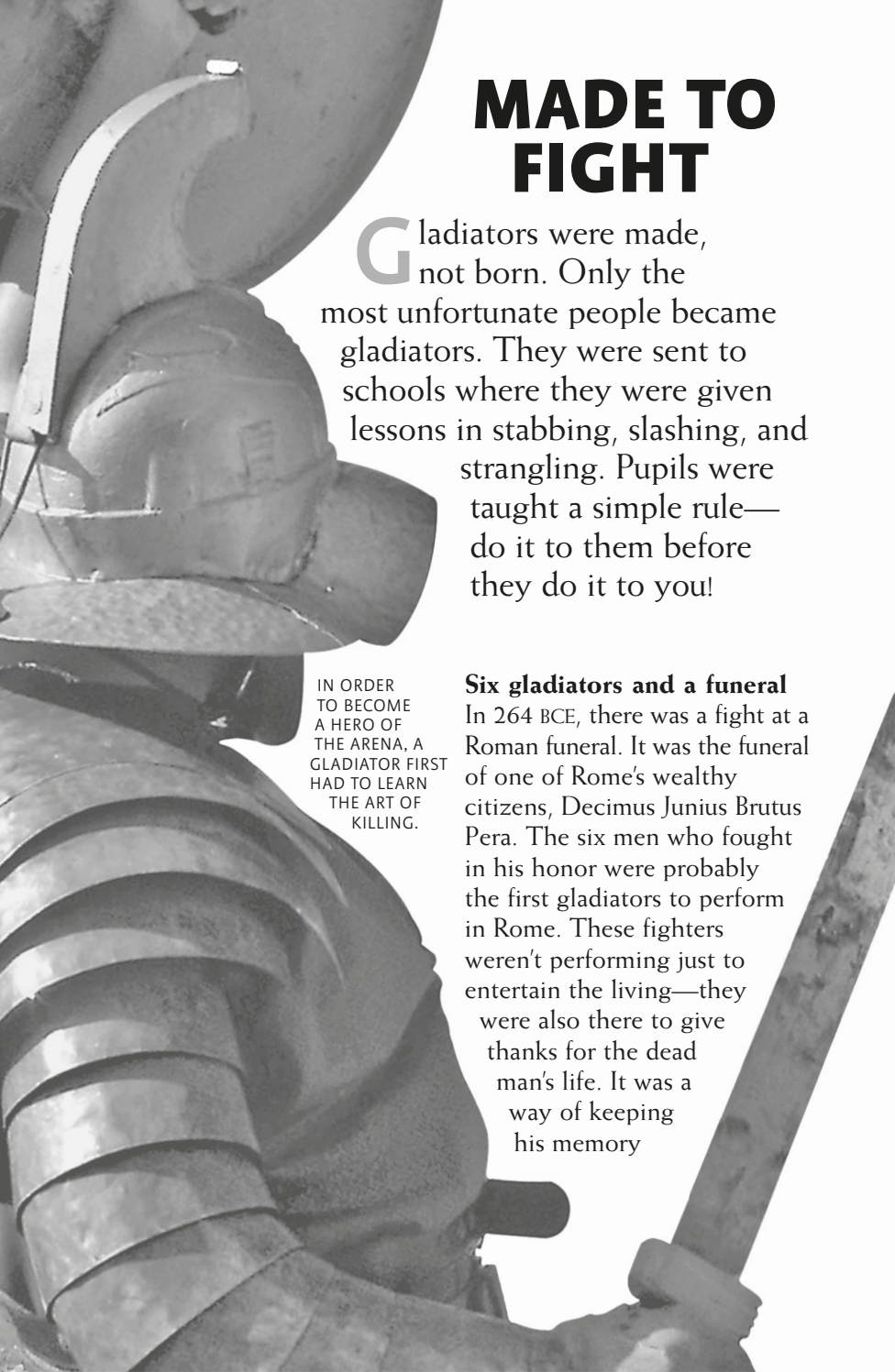




MADE TO FIGHT

Gladiators were made, not born. Only the most unfortunate people became gladiators. They were sent to schools where they were given lessons in stabbing, slashing, and strangling. Pupils were taught a simple rule—do it to them before they do it to you!

IN ORDER
TO BECOME
A HERO OF
THE ARENA, A
GLADIATOR FIRST
HAD TO LEARN
THE ART OF
KILLING.

Six gladiators and a funeral

In 264 BCE, there was a fight at a Roman funeral. It was the funeral of one of Rome's wealthy citizens, Decimus Junius Brutus Pera. The six men who fought in his honor were probably the first gladiators to perform in Rome. These fighters weren't performing just to entertain the living—they were also there to give thanks for the dead man's life. It was a way of keeping his memory